

Faster RAM Chips

Researchers at IBM created dynamic memory computer chips based on an experimental design that could retrieve a single bit of information in 20 billionths of a second. This Dynamic RAM (DRAM) memory was four times faster than the fastest RAM chips available at the time. The engineers also developed an experimental one-million-bit static random access memory (SRAM) chip, which was also the densest chip of its kind.

duplicate itself every 90 seconds. This caused the computers to eventually slow down or crash as the number of virus processes running in the background increased. During this period, the virus would scan for other computers connected to the network and look for security holes in the OS and networks that it could bypass to infect another machine. It also used the sendmail protocol to send infected emails from the host computer.

The virus caused 60,000 computers, including those of military and research installations, across the US to be shut down, causing quite a few heads to turn. The virus pointed out a number of security holes in the UNIX OS that had been discarded as being non-threatening. The worm also reiterated the importance of logs. Quite a few people were not able to find a solution to the problem since they did not maintain logs and therefore didn't know how they were getting infected.

When system administrators started discovering that the virus also used sendmail to send out infected emails, they shut down their mail servers. This caused more harm than good since the virus had other methods of attack and doing so only delayed a chain mail doing the rounds that explained how to remove the virus from reaching affected users.